

CCD Board Meeting – June 7, 2026

Attendees

- Philip Ogston
- Myra Mitchell
- Larry Lankford
- Valerie Allendorf
- Charles Wallner
- Bonnie Carpenter
- Deven Corzine
- Audrey Eyman
- Richard House

Key Topics & Detailed Discussion Summaries

1. Administrative Updates (Minutes, Reports, Scheduling)

- Prior meeting minutes were reviewed and accepted without changes.
- Treasurer's report was presented; no major concerns or questions were raised.
- Social secretary reported no recent activity (no cards sent).
- Scheduling for upcoming events was finalized and published.
- Calling language policy (caller's choice) was reviewed:
 - Data suggests no meaningful attendance difference between calling styles.
 - More callers are choosing "Larks and Robins," but both styles remain in use.
 - Board consensus supports maintaining flexibility and allowing caller choice.
- Minor adjustments were made to how calling terms are presented publicly to reduce confusion for new attendees.

2. Community Engagement & Attendance Growth

- Meetup platform launch is showing early positive results:
 - ~50 people signed up; several are attending repeatedly.
 - Growth is driven by both Meetup and word-of-mouth.
 - Emphasis on improving newcomer experience:
 - Personal greetings and engagement are key.
 - Additional engagement strategies discussed:
 - Promoting Saturday dances at Monday events.
 - Increased presence on Facebook and Meetup.
 - Potential outreach to external communities (schools, festivals, demonstrations).
-

3. Financial Sustainability & Sliding Scale Pricing

- Significant discussion on covering operating costs:
 - Current admission often does not meet expenses.
 - Estimated break-even ~ \$7 per attendee for Monday dances.
 - Proposed approach:
 - Introduce **clear messaging** explaining cost per dancer.
 - Use announcements (instead of signage initially) to educate attendees.
 - Maintain accessibility:
 - Free/discount options remain (students, first-timers, etc.).
 - Use of Pig Town profits:
 - Currently subsidizing operations.
 - Long-term goal is to **break even on regular dances** and redirect surplus to mission-driven initiatives.
-

4. Saturday Dance Strategy

- Ongoing concern about lower attendance on Saturdays.
- Identified contributing factors:
 - Higher admission cost
 - Competing weekend activities
- Strategies discussed:
 - Promote Saturday dances more actively
 - Add themes, social elements, and snacks
 - Highlight higher-quality or regional talent
 - Increase community/social appeal
- **Decision made** to extend Saturday dances:
 - New schedule: **7:30 PM – 10:30 PM**

- Goal: increase perceived value and attract regional participants
-

5. Talent Compensation Increase Proposal

- Proposal to increase pay for musicians, callers, and sound staff:
 - Structured tiered payments based on band size
 - Caller compensation increased from the proposed \$30 to \$50
 - Rationale:
 - Support talent retention and quality
 - Align compensation with organizational growth
 - Concerns discussed:
 - Budget impact
 - Risk of future financial pressure
 - Final outcome:
 - Proposal approved with modifications (see Decisions section)
 - File talent_pay_increase.xls has detailed summary of pay increases
-

6. Sponsorship Policy Development

- Interest in formalizing a **dance sponsorship program**:
 - Individuals can sponsor specific dances (e.g., birthdays, events)
 - Proposed structure:
 - Sponsor selects an existing scheduled dance (band/date)
 - Sponsorship provides recognition but limited control
 - Donations during event still encouraged for organization
 - Legal and administrative considerations raised:
 - Donation tracking
 - Required acknowledgment letters
 - Transparency requirements
 - Action: create formal written policy and supporting materials (flyer/template)
-

7. Organizational Strategy & Mission Expansion

- Discussion on long-term direction:
 - Current funds and reserves are healthy but limited (~1–2 years coverage)
 - Need to consider broader mission activities:

- Outreach programs
 - Educational initiatives
 - Community events
 - Emphasis on:
 - Not relying solely on Pig Town revenue
 - Building visibility outside existing dance community
-

8. Operational Improvements

- Board visibility update:
 - Need to update posted board member information (“board board”)
 - Volunteer processes:
 - Discussion of formalizing volunteer incentives (e.g., work-for-entry)
 - Messaging and announcements:
 - Rotating responsibility among board members
-

9. Personnel Changes

- One board member announced resignation effective immediately.
 - Departure includes stepping down from responsibilities and attendance.
 - Transition plan: temporary handling of materials until a replacement is chosen.
-

Key Decisions

1. **Saturday dances extended to 3 hours** (7:30–10:30 PM).
2. **Talent compensation increase approved**, including:
 - Revised tiered pay structure for bands.
 - Caller pay increased to **\$50 per event**. (originally \$30)
 - Adjusted band size compensation thresholds.
 - See Talent Pay Increase.xls
3. **Sliding scale messaging approach endorsed**:
 - Begin with announcements instead of fixed signage.
4. **Continue Meetup trial** (3-month evaluation period).
5. **Maintain caller’s choice policy** for calling language.
6. Agreement to **develop formal sponsorship policy** framework.

Key Action Items

- **Develop announcement script** explaining sliding scale and costs.
- **Calculate updated break-even costs** (including Saturdays).
- **Draft sponsorship policy and flyer/template.** (Charles)
- **Update board member display (“board board”)** with current members.
- **Coordinate Saturday dance promotion strategy** (announcements + regional outreach).
- **Confirm band/caller availability** for extended Saturday schedule.
- **Track Meetup effectiveness** and attendance conversion.
- **Explore outreach opportunities** (schools, festivals, community events).
- **Create clearer volunteer procedures** (setup/cleanup incentives).
- **Add New Year’s Eve dance planning to next agenda.**